

ALCARAZ ON THE REBOUND

The Spanish sensation battled hard to win his latest title at Indian Wells, **delivering incredible performances** against Daniil Medvedev and Jannik Sinner.

SINNER AND ALCARAZ HAD FAR DIFFERENT TRAJECTORIES GOING INTO THEIR DUEL

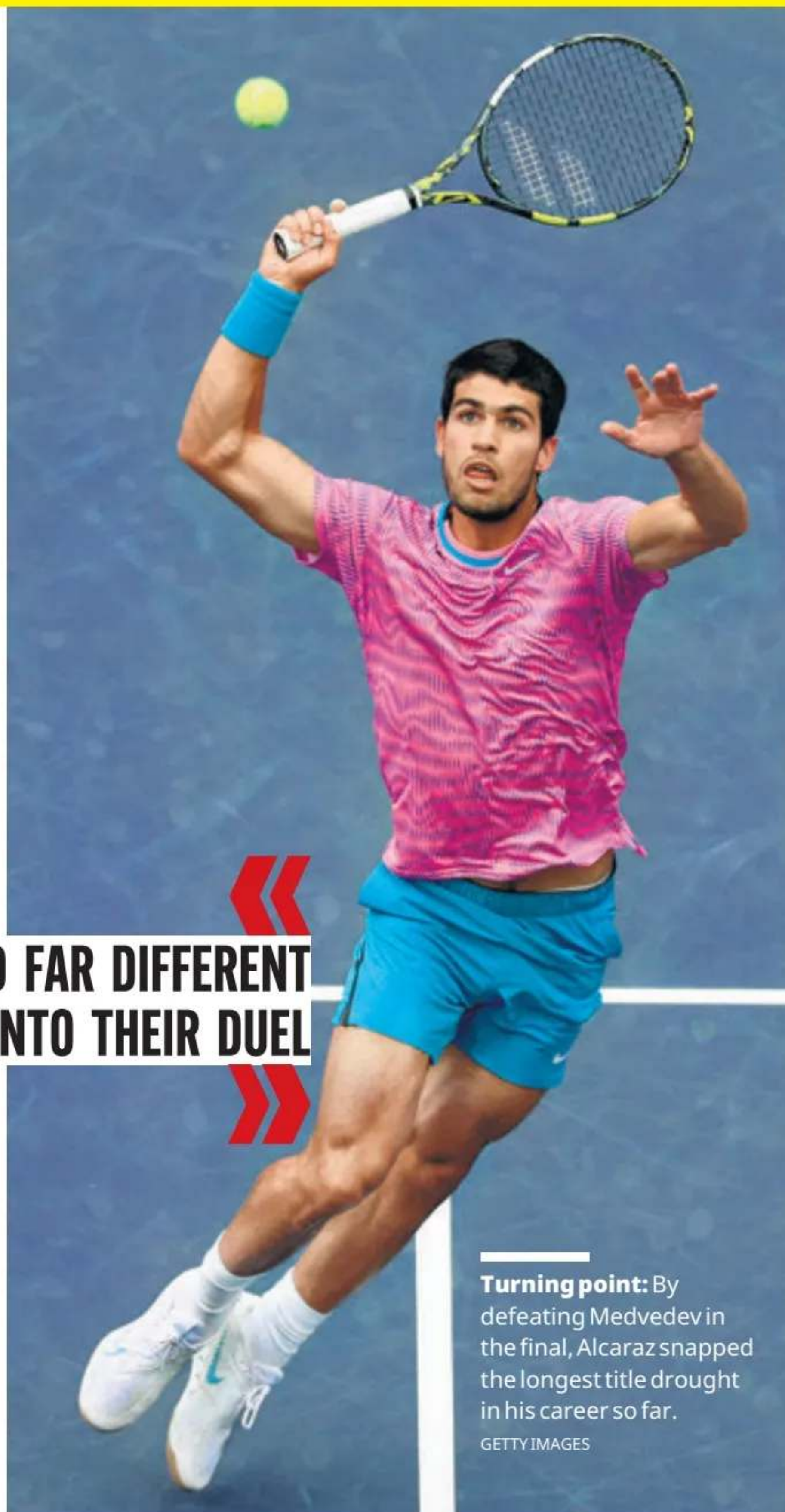
Paul Fein

"It's not a video game, but it's almost like it" — Tennis Channel analyst, Paul Annacone, on the spectacular athleticism and shot-making during Carlos Alcaraz's 1-6, 6-3, 6-2 semifinal victory over Jannik Sinner.

A dream showdown featuring the sport's most enticing new rivalry appeared inevitable at the tournament that calls itself 'Tennis Paradise.'

With shock and awe victories, Alcaraz and Sinner strutted into the semifinals at the BNP Paribas Open at Indian Wells. The dynamic Spaniard dropped just 22 games and the explosive Italian only 23 against four overmatched foes apiece.

Sinner, 22, and Alcaraz, 20, had far different trajectories going into their duel in the desert. Jannik, whose technically perfect game resembles Novak Djokovic's but with more power, had amassed a 19-0 winning streak (16-0 this season) and racked up a terrific 10-1



Turning point: By defeating Medvedev in the final, Alcaraz snapped the longest title drought in his career so far.

GETTY IMAGES

record against top-5 opponents in the past five months. Against his top rivals, Sinner led Djokovic 3-1, Alcaraz 1-0, and Daniil Medvedev 4-0.

In sharp contrast, Alcaraz hadn't won a tournament since he dethroned seven-time champion Djokovic in the memorable 2023 Wimbledon final. Poor planning and bad luck contributed to Alcaraz's disappointing, four-set quarterfinal loss to Alexander Zverev at the 2024 Australian Open. He didn't play a tune-up



FOR MORE
STORIES